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THE OBSERVER

20 OCTOBER 1968

Unions postpone strike

by DAVID HAWORTH, our Industrial Reporter

THE national engineering strike which was due to start at midnight tonight has been suspended by the rank-and-file committee of the Amalgamated Engineering and Foundry Workers' Union.

After a day of fierce argument and recrimination they decided, by a narrow majority, to put off the decision whether to strike until Monday, 4 November.

In the first of two votes the AEF national committee declared against the earlier recommendation by Mr Hugh Scanlon, the union's president, that the strike should start tomorrow.

In the second vote (29-23) they agreed to meet again in two weeks' time. After the AEF decision the 29-strong Confederation of Shipbuilding and Engineering Unions endorsed the strike postponement decision. But they will question whether to continue formal negotiations with the employers or bargain in future with individual firms.

Mr Scanlon was grim-faced after the 3-hour meeting during which there was a lot of shouting with cries of 'Shut up' and 'Sit down'.

The postponement has brought great relief to Government Ministers and officials. They now hold out hopes that there could be an amicable settlement between now and 4 November when the AEF national committee meets again.

Mrs Barbara Castle, Secretary for Em-

ployment and Productivity, said 'It's a triumph for common sense and the national interest. The trade unions' attitude to the employers' offer was 'very confused' and the Confederation of Shipbuilding and Engineering Unions wanted more time to consider it.

The executives of the 29 unions within the confederation will meet next Friday to consider their next tactics.

The rank-and-file decision is a severe setback for Mr Scanlon and his more militant pro-strike supporters who had almost convinced themselves that some 3,500,000 workers would be idle from tomorrow morning. Mr Scanlon, the man who refused to take a strike ballot among his members, has now been repudiated by the rank-and-file representatives at the first opportunity they had to give their verdict since the original strike decision of 31 August.

The Amalgamated Engineering and Foundry Workers' Union national committee meeting in Transport House, London, had taken a gloomy view of the settlement proposals thrashed out during last week's marathon negotiating sessions.

Mr Scanlon outlined to the committee large concessions he had made to the employers in restrictive practices, hours of work and training in return for higher minimum rates and longer holidays.

The employers said they had made their 'final offer', but many union delegates

felt there were too many 'strings' attached to it for them to be able to sell the deal to their shop floor members.

Furthermore, the talks had broken down the previous evening on the question of women's pay. Agreement had been near when a woman on the union negotiating team accused her colleagues of 'selling the women' by giving skilled workers more money at their expense.

Mrs Castle was furious that this crucial issue had not been brought into the negotiations much earlier in the week. In employers' minds it abundantly clear that there was no more money 'in the kitty' to give women workers £13 or £14 a week after three years (compared with £15 for unskilled men and £19 for skilled men).

The union delegates have still to decide whether they are prepared to stage a national strike—which the Prime Minister has said could be 'disastrous'—on behalf of women workers.

Seven women, representing the industry's 500,000 women workers, said yesterday they would be in favour of a national strike, although they were suspicious that their male colleagues, despite good intentions, would not want to strike on their behalf alone. These fears have now been confirmed.

Mrs Castle said there was never any question of achieving equal pay at one blow in these negotiations. It was merely a question of narrowing the differentials



Mr Scanlon holds a last-minute kerbside conference.

between rates for men and women. 'It was and still is open to the trade unions to get differentials more favourable to women in this package deal.' The employers, Mrs Castle said, had offered to set up a committee to examine how, by job evaluation schemes, to measure women's pay. 'The real answer on equal pay is to get away from the whole concept of a special rate for women.'

It has emerged that the AEF has agreed 'unreservedly' that production and manpower in the industry should be deployed and used more efficiently. This is regarded as a substantial victory for the employers who had previously always been told by Mr Scanlon that there could be no discussions on productivity until the basic pay questions were settled.

Just how this union undertaking to co-operate in the removal of restrictive

practices is to be organised remained unclear last night. Nevertheless the promise is a firm one. The union pledges not to resist in principle the introduction of shift working, the planned use of working hours and to co-operate in dropping restrictive practices such as the over-manning of machines and production lines.

On training, the union has also agreed to a revision of the present age limits for apprentices and a redefinition of the craftsman's status. In return, the employers have conceded on 'mutuality' that is, the system of negotiating wage rates over and above rates decided by work measurement methods. They have always regarded this as an inflationary element in their wage costs but backed down after it looked as though the talks would be abandoned over this issue.

Police will appease marchers

by ERIC CLARK

LONDON POLICE want it to be known that they have decided on a policy of appeasement at next Sunday's anti-Vietnam war demonstration.

If demonstrators stage a sit-down in Whitehall, police will let them, adopting a patient, standing-by attitude. If protesters surge across the whole width of roads, police will divert traffic rather than try to force the marchers back.

Under no circumstances will they use tear gas, fire-hoses or erect barricades to cordon off buildings.

The key to police tactics will be to react to much of what happens, and to be seen to be doing so. Their aim is to show that they are in agreement with the demonstrators' right to protest, are actively helping to see that the organisation works, and will use force only when nothing else is possible.

Nearly 7,000 police will be on duty, but will be kept out of sight as much as possible. All are from the Metropolitan Police area; none is being drafted in from outside, and no troops will be used.

Many of the police on duty have recently been given special crowd-control training at Hendon—but only in traditional police methods, such as interlocking arms to face a crowd. Police horses will be used, even though the plan is to keep them hidden unless they are needed.

Up to 30,000 demonstrators are expected on the march. The route leads along the 1-mile-long Fleet Street, Whitehall, Victoria, to Hyde Park, where there will be a mass rally.

Key buildings on the route will be guarded in case demonstrators try to occupy them. The buildings include the Daily Telegraph, Australia House, Rhodesia House, and Scotland Yard.

Less obvious targets for demonstrators will not have a special police guard. Senior buses and coaches, which would only make them more obvious. Owners of these buildings have, however, been advised to lock doors and to have staff on duty inside, in case fire bombs are thrown.

Command HQ

A second march of more militant Maoists will split off at Trafalgar Square. The target is the American Embassy. Up to 6,000 are expected on this march. The buildings include the more militant police have one thing on their side: Grosvenor Square is ideal territory in which to 'box off' demonstrators if they become violent.

With demonstrators travelling from all over Britain, buses and coaches will be stopped and searched for weapons. But police expect to find none. If any are being brought to London, they would be carried in private cars or vans separately.

The most likely time for violence will be in the evening—after the Hyde Park rally—when some protesters break off into small groups. Police will be placed at likely trouble spots throughout London-like London's own hotels—but senior officers know that it is impossible to plan this stage of the day with precision.

Scotland Yard's officer in charge of demonstrators, Commander John Taylor, will be in command on the streets with the marchers. But, additionally, for the first time there will be a command headquarters in Scotland Yard. The Commissioner, Sir John Widdowson, is expected to stay at the Yard all day.

All the Yard's plans are meant to prevent violence, even at the cost of great provocation. This, they believe, is of vital long-term importance. A violent demonstration could, many officers believe, be the start of a whole new sequence of similar events.

Roland Huntford reports from Stockholm. Vietnam representatives who have opened an 'information centre' here are working with the Vietnam committee of the Stockholm Vietnam Conference, an international body co-ordinating protest activities in Western Europe. The conference disclaims all connection with the London demonstration. From this, it would appear that Farquhar and the demonstration does not have the approval of Hanoi or the Vietnam



Stephen Pollock, 22-year-old heir of Viscount Hanworth, with Elizabeth Vambe, 21, a Rhodesian-born African, after their marriage yesterday at Edmonton register office.

They are both students at Sussex University and met two and a half years ago in a public library at Guildford.

She was given away by her father, Mr Lawrence Vambe, a former newspaper editor in Salisbury, Rhodesia.

After the wedding Mr Pollock said: 'We are both very strong-minded on the race issue and shall work together on it.' Lord Hanworth, the second viscount, said: 'We would have no race troubles if we had more of this integration.'

Space men get cabin drill

HOUSTON, TEXAS, 19 October.—Apollo 7's commander, Walter Schirra, turned drill sergeant and directed his two fellow astronauts in a comedy telecast from space today. 'Hup, two, three, four,' he shouted as Air Force Major Donn Eisele and civilian astronaut Walter Cunningham briskly went through military marching manoeuvres. 'About face, left face, forward march.'

In their weightless world, they looked comical as they floated free in their roomy cabin.

100 m.p.h. Gladys

MIAMI, 19 October.—The hurricane Gladys, after a destructive crossing of Florida, was blowing at more than 100 miles an hour tonight towards the United States Atlantic coast. Emergency warnings were issued along the coast from Charleston, South Carolina, to Cape Hatteras, AP.

£25,000 Prize Bond

The weekly £25,000 Premium Bond prize, announced yesterday, was won by bond number 211, 297,554.

Jackie: We're very happy

SKORPIOS ISLAND, 19 October

MRS JACQUELINE KENNEDY posed for photographers today on this tiny Greek island where she marries Aristotle Onassis tomorrow and said: 'Tellis and I are very happy.'

Tellis is apparently Mrs Kennedy's nickname for 62-year-old Onassis. She looked radiantly happy as she came ashore from Onassis's yacht Christina with her children, Caroline, 10, and John, eight. Onassis stayed aboard. Later he took her and the children on a motor-boat cruise.

Tonight, Mrs Kennedy issued an appeal to the world's Press to respect the privacy of the marriage ceremony. 'We wish our wedding to be a private moment in the little chapel among the cypresses of Skoprios with only members of the family present, five of them little children,' she said.

Earlier, there had been fist-fights on Skoprios between Pressmen and members of Onassis's staff.

CHARLES FOLEY reports from Rome: It was suggested in the Vatican today that the Greek Orthodox Church may have granted Onassis a dissolution of his first marriage, thus removing the religious barriers to his marriage to Mrs Kennedy. It is thought that this may have been done at a private hearing in Athens or Salonika, and that the rush wedding follows a period of careful preparation.

The intention, it is believed, was to keep the wedding secret until after the ceremony, but this was frustrated when the news broke in America.

Onassis's divorce from Tina Livanos, now the Marchioness of Blandford, was granted by a civil court in Alabama, US, in 1960. It was not, however, recognised by the Orthodox Church which married them in 1945. If therefore, Onassis married Mrs Kennedy without further formalities he would be regarded by his Church as a bigamist. For her part the second Mrs Onassis would be regarded by the Roman Catholic Church as a concubine and would

almost certainly be excluded from the sacraments.

Mrs Kennedy is well versed in her Church's views on the marriage bond. Her attempts from the White House to help obtain an annulment of the first marriage of her sister Lee (now Princess Stanislas Radziwill) who lives in London) caused some embarrassment at the Vatican during the summer of 1961. The case was re-examined by the Sacred Rota in the following year and an annulment was granted, but it was emphasised to Mrs Kennedy that her intervention had not been helpful.

The Orthodox Church, however, is far less concerned with its image abroad and much more susceptible to influence, especially from a quarter as powerful as Onassis. Dissolution of his church marriage to Tina Livanos would free him to marry Mrs Kennedy and she, in turn, would merely need a dispensation from her Church for a 'mixed marriage'. This is fairly easily granted and it would allow her to marry either in a Catholic or an Orthodox church.

Both Churches would insist that the children of the marriage should be brought up in their faith. Presumably the parties would each make a nominal promise to this effect.

Mrs Joseph Kennedy, mother of the late President, said in Chicago she believed the couple would live in New York.

Why she chose Onassis

by a Staff Reporter

GREEK shipping tycoons aren't the most lovable breed of businessmen. The rich ones are so disgustingly rich, and their buccannery approach to tax and exchange control is so peculiarly virulent.

Onassis runs beautifully-kept ships and so does Nearchos, his rival and thorn in the flesh. But his speech, the more mature he was, the more likely they were to let him in. The family were tobacco merchants in Smyrna, living under Turkish oppression after the Turks captured it in 1922. Onassis went off to rebuild their modest fortunes, and did rather better than expected.

Having clocked up his first million dollars in the import-export business by the time he was 25, he bought some laid-up freighters when the slump was at its worst in 1931, built his first tanker before the war, and

but that they go about it more discreetly and politely than Aristotle Onassis: both to his advantage.

His life business and private, some how builds up a red-blooded image—that American tycoons are generally too boyish or naïve to achieve. If it's true, as gossips and friends say, that Mrs Kennedy is fed up with the Kennedy clan, and with being part of a legend that freezes her at one dreadful moment of time, then 'one can see how she might be attracted to her as an ideal choice for a modern protector—committed to looking after her for ever and ever, in a zone of society where she feels at home with the rich, the talkative, the travel-led and the worldly-wise. But as one commentator remarked, it's the worst insult to American manhood since Pearl Harbour.

Everyone agrees that Onassis is a charmer who knows how to flatter and especially women by giving them great blasts of concentrated attention. When in Athens he anchors his yacht Christina off Glyfada, a seaside area just east of the airport, and whoops up in moderation at one of the local night clubs. More than one Athenian tavern has made a name for itself on the strength of rowdy evenings inspired by Onassis who smashes blocks of plate glass and plays guitar-type music of the bouzouki.

Onassis is to be 62 years old and not 68 or 69, as some papers say. According to Will Frischauer in his 1968 biography, 'Onassis', he added years to his life by marrying a young man, he emigrated from Europe to make his fortune in the Argentine—then the more mature he was, the more likely they were to let him in.

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Briton shoots a Gold

BRITAIN won a second Gold medal at the Mexico Olympics yesterday when Bob Braithwaite, a 43-year-old veterinary surgeon from Preston, won the clay pigeon shooting competition.

Christopher Brasher, captain of the Black Power team at the Olympics has cooled considerably. Tommie Smith and John Carlos, who demonstrated with 'black gloves' on the victory podium on Thursday and who were suspended late that night, are to be allowed to stay in Mexico until the end of the Games if they wish.

Athletically the American Negroes have done even better than usual in these Games. Of the 27 medals at stake in the men's track events, they have won 10, while Africa's Negroes have won nine, and whites have won eight.

Lee Evans was asked to explain why they had done so well. 'My own view, he said, is that this is our only outlet. I wouldn't have won a scholarship to go to university, but I didn't run fast. Maybe the boy doesn't need to try so hard because his parents can afford to send him to school.'

Surviving babies make good progress

Three of the surviving Birmingham sextuplets have made such good progress that no further bulletin will be issued. Birmingham Children's Hospital, where the fourth baby, Lynne, is detained after two intestinal operations, said yesterday that there had been a further slight improvement in her condition.

After 1943, taking everything on the tin-tucker, business. His personal wealth accumulated and 'zoomed' into the tens of millions. He was a good gambler, especially at roulette, where he rates money quickly, especially when there are wars and political unrest; and, like other financiers on the international circuit, he can change his mind quickly. He has a 'least tax'.

Many, probably most, companies that make and sell worldwide use countries like Switzerland, Liechtenstein, Curaçao, the Bahamas, and Panama as collecting grounds for income. They can't avoid all tax, because the money will be taxed in the first instance by the countries where the business is carried on. But the businessmen must be able to get their money out of the country in ships, which spend most of their time at sea.

For tax purposes the ship is held to be part of whichever country it's registered in. By using flags of convenience and registering his ships in a low-tax country like Panama, the owner avoids tax. As a shipowner, Onassis has been involved in a few scuffles with the authorities. The US Government indicted him (and others) in 1954, alleging that he controlled a company which bought 20 surplus US tankers, thus violating a law which said that the purchasers must be American. The eventual settlement cost him \$7 million. In the same year his whaling factory ship, the Peruvian, was bombed by the Peruvian Air Force for allegedly working inside a 200-mile offshore limit.

The laconic ease with which he sails through both this sort of crisis and personal matters, like his engagement with Maria Callas, give him a suggestion of coolness and perhaps contempt for the tiny bureaucrats and moralists who live in that other world of frontiers and income tax.

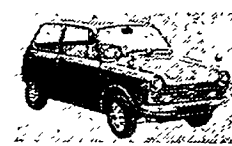
He is, as he seems to enjoy his endless feud with his fellow-shipowner Stavros Niarchos, a Greek, and his sister, the daughter of the Greek shipowner, Stavros Livanos. Onassis was divorced by Athina (or Tina), now the Marchioness of Blandford, in 1960. Niarchos was divorced by

(Continued on Page 3)

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TODAY'S WEATHER

S.E. ENGLAND will be dry with some bright intervals. Other parts of England will be mostly cloudy, with outbreaks of rain but brighter weather will spread into extreme western areas later.
LONDON, S.E. ENGLAND: Rather cloudy and misty at first, but bright intervals developing. Dry. Wind S. light or moderate. Rather warm, 16C.
CENTRAL S.E. N. ENGLAND: Rather cloudy and with outbreaks of rain. A few bright intervals. Wind S. moderate. Rather warm, 15C., 59F.
S.W. and N.W. ENGLAND: WALSLEY: Mostly cloudy at first, with rain in places. Becoming brighter from W. later. Wind S. moderate or fresh. Rather warm, 15C., 59F.
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mushroom. 49/11

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sears, lined. Cork or oatmeal.
(Foreign). 33/11

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Zambia halts mission by MPs

by our Political Correspondent

AT BARELY 24 hours' notice a British parliamentary mission to Zambia, due to have left London last night, has been indefinitely postponed.

The cancellation by the Zambian authorities was thought in Government circles to be connected with recent racial disturbances reported from the copperbelt, which led to the sudden expulsion of 25 Europeans, 12 of them British.

The Commonwealth Office complained that they should have been given longer warning, but the case for the expulsions was not challenged. Private information reaching London suggested the people involved may have been concerned in racial provocation. President Kaunda has been actively campaigning against racialism in Zambia, and it was believed in London that he may have been right in thinking it would be better for these troubles to simmer down before the arrival of the British delegation.

Main reason

The eight MPs in the intended mission, led by former Minister of Transport Mr Tom Fraser and including the former Conservative Attorney-General, Sir John Hobson, QC, were told that because of the pressure of business it would be difficult to make appropriate arrangements for the distinguished visitors. There was no proposal for a later date.

The visit had been arranged several months ago by the Zambian branch of the Parliamentary Commonwealth Association and by the Speaker's Office at Lusaka, but it is understood in London these had inadvertently failed to inform their own Foreign Office until Thursday.

This may have been a contributory factor in deciding the Zambian authorities to call off the visit, though London believes the main reason was the recent disturbances.

Not compromised

British officials were at pains to deny that relations with Zambia are seriously compromised. They point out that Zambia is still considering the offer of £14 million intended to help them compensate for trade losses with Rhodesia, and that the High Commissioner has been given full authority to make the payment as soon as President Kaunda decides to accept.

Nothing he has said so far indicates a rupture of relations and they believe he is waiting only for a decision on the Rhodesian issue before taking up the offer. They claim that the social contacts between the two countries have remained good and point out that under the aid programme there are more professional and technical staff sent out from Britain to Zambia than to any other country.

'Enough of this sorrow'

BANGKOK, 29 October — President Johnson appealed to North Vietnamese leaders today: 'Let us lay aside our arms and sit down at the table of reason.'

He promised that as soon as the Vietnam war ended it would be possible to devote substantially greater funds to the relief of human misery. South-East Asia would have its full share. The President was speaking at Chulalongkorn University in Bangkok on the second day of his visit to Thailand.

He said: 'I say to the leaders in Hanoi: let us renounce the works of death and take up the tasks of the living. Enough of this sorrow.'

Americans in Thailand: Page 2

Human wave attack

SAIGON, 29 October — North Vietnam troops came on in 'human waves' in a new onslaught against United States infantrymen in the central highlands of South Vietnam last night. The battle is still going on.

In one of five big attacks screaming troops hurled themselves against an American company to the sound of bugles, advancing from all sides at once, a military spokesman said. Moderate US casualties are reported.



Listening to a first-hand account of the Aberfan disaster.

GLYNNE JONES

Queen visits the mourning valley

from ALAN ROAD, Aberfan, 29 October

THE MOURNING citizens of Aberfan gave the Queen a silent welcome when she visited their stricken village with the Duke of Edinburgh today.

There were no cheers. It was, after all, a royal occasion which everyone concerned was wishing had not been necessary.

But it was a visit of a mother, a visit which, in the words of Councillor Jim Williams, who lost seven relatives in last week's disaster, was beneficial to the mothers who lost their children.

It was outside Aelbybryn (brow of the hill), the councillor's home, that three-year-old Karen Jones presented the Queen with a small posy inscribed 'From the remaining children of Aberfan.'

Tea and Welsh cakes

For 20 minutes over tea and Welsh cakes in the front room of the green-and-yellow terraced house, Mr Williams and his 62-year-old wife, Beatrice, told the Queen and Prince Philip of the disaster morning when the great tip above Aberfan swept over the village school and 17 houses killing 146 and robbing Mr Williams of three young nephews, two sisters-in-law, one brother-in-law and an aunt.

Earlier, from the other side of the narrow Merthyr Valley, the Queen and the Duke had viewed the monochrome landscape of disaster, the grey, terraced houses in tiers, culminated by the long black finger of slurry pointing at the heart of the village. The royal couple crossed the floor of the valley to inspect the scene of the disaster

at closer quarters and speak with rescuers and rescued.

At Bwthyn, the Welsh Congregational chapel—until a few days ago a temporary mortuary—the Queen talked to four nurses and St John workers who had tolled inside. In Moy Road, where only half an hour earlier giant lorries had been removing mountains of black mud, the Queen and the Duke stood on the site of Pantglas school, now no more than an 80-yard gap in the road.

Mr Williams introduced the Queen to half a dozen families who had been bereaved or had lost homes. 'She was very sorry,' he said, 'there was nothing she could give them other than just sympathy.'

For the Duke the two-and-a-half-hour visit was the second paid to the village in eight days, and he chatted with men of the King's Own Borderers who have been helping in the cleaning up since the weekend.

In Aberfan Road, the Queen paused to speak to Mrs Margaret Harries, of Cotrell Road, and her two sons, Paul, aged six, and Robert, aged seven. She was told how Paul's life was saved by Mrs Nancy Williams, a dinner-money collector at Pantglas school, who covered Paul's body with her own and perished in its ruins.

Later, the royal couple paid an unscheduled visit to the village cemetery on the hillside overlooking Aberfan and only a quarter of a mile from the path of the sliding tip.

There, watched by a handful of villagers, the Queen and Duke together placed a wreath of pink carnations on the mass grave of the 81 victims buried on Thursday. For the moment,

the Queen, whose rust coat echoed the colour of the trunks on the surrounding hills, stood before the grave with head bowed.

Then, with the mayor of Merthyr, Alderman Stanley Davies, she climbed the steep hillside to visit the 150-foot cross of flowers sent to Aberfan from all parts of the world.

But today the rest of the world respected official requests to 'stay away and leave Aberfan to its grief. Almost as soon as the royal party left for the East Glamorgan hospital where they saw more survivors, the giant lorries were back at work and Aberfan began to return to normal—or as normal as a village that has lost more than a hundred children can ever be again.

Mr Lee was asked about newspaper reports that the Spanish radio had threatened to broadcast a speech that the only thing left for Gibraltarians was to take the apes and leave.

Mr Lee replied: 'Spain can have the apes and we'll have the Rock.'

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Yard suspects Blake used two-way radio

by PETER DEELEY

America accused of spy frame-up

Moscow, 29 October

THE United States was accused by the Soviet newspaper *Izvestia* tonight of framing a Soviet diplomat in Washington.

It said Mr John Huminit, a Maryland scientist, had worked as a double agent and had planted classified material with Mr Valentin Kevan, a third secretary at the Soviet Embassy.

It was claimed that Mr Huminit had sold the Russians information about the US space programme while keeping the FBI informed. As a result of his evidence the Soviet diplomat was declared persona non grata.

The newspaper named Mr Huminit and a Mr Harry Barnes, whom it described as an American Government official, as provocateurs. It said Mr Barnes tried to recruit Soviet officials as double agents for the CIA and attempted to compromise other Soviet officials by showing them official documents.

It said that Mr Huminit met a Soviet specialist, whom it did not identify, and left him a secret document containing information on US chemical and bacteriological weapons. This led to his expulsion from the US.

Izvestia also accused Mr Valentin Kevan, 50-year-old Soviet director of Harvard's Russian Research Centre, with censoring the mail of Soviet students and using blackmail to force them to spy for the USSR. Mr Shulman is now visiting Moscow as a tourist. They also accused the Central Intelligence Agency and the Soviet Bureau of Investigation of using spies and technicians for any activity.

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SPECIAL BRANCH and Scotland Yard detectives carrying out investigations inside Wormwood Scrubs prison into the escape of master-spy George Blake believe that he may have been communicating with outside sources by a two-way, short-wave transmitter.

All work was stopped in the prison radio workshop last week after a search by the inquiry team. Prisoners working there were directed to other jobs, the section was sealed off and equipment was impounded.

The investigators believe that Blake was using the two-way radio to complete his escape arrangements during the 24 hours before he climbed to liberty.

A man with knowledge of the prison said yesterday: 'It is not the first time that men inside have used radios to make contact with the world outside.'

Scotland Yard officers were making inquiries in Dublin yesterday. They want to talk to an Irishman who completed a seven-year sentence in Wormwood Scrubs last April and is known to have been friendly with Blake.

Although the man is believed to be living in Britain, police think the key to where he is may be in Ireland.

350 prisoners questioned

Every member of the prison staff and all the 350 long-term prisoners—those serving more than three years—have been questioned.

The prison authorities have drawn up a list of 30 potential escapees still housed within D Block, the wing from which Blake escaped through a second-floor window. The men include murderers, others guilty of crimes of severe violence, and some sentenced for fraud, have been graded into maximum, medium and possible security risks.

Following the investigation, the prison authorities are likely to make more transfers to other parts of the prison to make more secure.

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GEORGE BLAKE —an Observer inquiry

IN COLOUR

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Africa's wounded giant

MY FACE AND I

The baffled men of business

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Queen Elizabeth and the Duke of Edinburgh talk to an Aberfan schoolgirl.

GLYNNE JONES



THE OBSERVER

London, Sunday, 6 November 1966

ESTABLISHED 1791 No. 9,148 PRICE 8d.



The Alternative President

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Lawyers will urge divorce by consent

by a Staff Reporter

THE Law Commission is expected to recommend divorce by consent in a report to the Lord Chancellor which will be published this week.

This will be the first major reform of substantive law to be recommended by this new body of paid servants of the Crown, set up last year by the Government under the inspiration of the Lord Chancellor, Lord Gardiner, and with Mr Justice Scarman as chairman.

It is understood that the Commission has broadly accepted the

analysis of the report of the Archbishop of Canterbury's Committee, headed by the Bishop of Exeter, Dr Robert Mortimer. This committee reported in July and recommended the abolition of the doctrine of the matrimonial offence, i.e. adultery, cruelty or desertion, and its substitution by a new doctrine of the irrevocable breakdown of the marriage.

The Law Commission is unable to accept this recommendation, largely because of the immense volume of work which it would involve for the courts. Instead it

plumps for the simpler remedy of divorce by consent after a given number of years separation. It is understood that the Commission has deferred certain important issues such as the question of the children of a marriage and the apportionment of property between the parties. Recommendations on these will follow later.

Failure ten years ago

The report is bound to be highly controversial. Neither the Roman Catholic nor the Anglican Churches could possibly accept the concept of divorce by consent without going back on long-held doctrines.

There may also be some criticism of the Commission for going beyond what was understood to be its proper function of tackling branches of the law which are unclear or contradictory. What it has done is to tackle a controversial branch of the law in the spirit of a Royal Commission.

The last Royal Commission on Marriage and Divorce reported 10 years ago but was hopelessly divided in its recommendations. It is its failure to agree that has given the Law Commission its title to take charge of the issue.

Members of the Commission were in session at Oxford early last summer together with members of Archbishop Ramsey's committee.

Private Bill for reform

Among those present on this occasion was Sir Jocelyn Simon, the Lord Chief Justice. It is understood that he was then over to a considerable measure of acceptance of the concept of divorce by consent.

An attempt by Mr Leo Abse, Labour MP for Pontypool, to add marriage breakdown to existing grounds for divorce failed three years ago. But he was given leave by the House of Commons last month to introduce a new Private Member's Bill with this object.

Members of the Law Commission are Mr Laurence Gower, Professor of Law at the University of Lagos; Mr Neil Lawson, QC, Recorder of Folkestone; Mr Norman Marsh, formerly Director of the British Institute of International and Comparative Law; and Mr Andrew Martin, Professor of International and Comparative Law, University of Southampton.

Man flees from police guard in hospital

by PETER DEELEY

A MAN under observation by detectives in a London hospital escaped yesterday after leaving a dummy figure made out of books in the bed of his private room.

After an extensive police search no trace had been found of him last night. His identity is not being revealed but he is understood to be a vital witness in a large-scale Scotland Yard investigation.

The man had been detained for questioning. No charge had been preferred against him and he was being kept under surveillance partly for his own safety. It was feared that a London gang might harm him.

The man, a chickenpox suspect, escaped from Hither Green isolation hospital early yesterday morning. He was being kept under a 24-hour guard on the hospital's first floor.

After his disappearance, a dressing gown and pyjamas were found in the hospital grounds. Police believe that he got away in a waiting car.

On Friday, four men went to visit him in hospital but the police guards, acting on instructions to check every caller, allowed only one person, a relative, into the room.

Salvation Army offers to play

THE Salvation Army has volunteered to step into the breach left by the Scots Guards' band's refusal to play at next Sunday's memorial service for Rhodesian war dead.

The offer, by the Army's Chalk Farm, N. London, branch, was made yesterday to Mr Tom Lawler, secretary of the Anglo-Rhodesian Society, organisers of the service.

Mr Lawler said last night: 'Presumably there can be no controversy about a religious organisation providing music for a religious ceremony. On Friday, 24 hours after agreeing to play, the Scots Guards' band withdrew on advice from the Commonwealth Relations Office because of its 'political consequence'.

Wilson receives Smith's answer

by our Political Correspondent

Mr Ian Smith's answer to the Government's proposal for bringing Rhodesia back to constitutional rule was received by Mr Wilson yesterday.

Mr Wilson discussed it over the telephone with Mr Geoffrey Howe, Secretary of State for the Colonies, and Mr Herbert Morrison, Secretary of State for the Commonwealth. Mr Wilson also discussed it with Mr Norman Marsh, formerly Director of the British Institute of International and Comparative Law, and Mr Andrew Martin, Professor of International and Comparative Law, University of Southampton.

In Salisbury last night Mr Smith said his message contained 'firm and definite proposals' for a settlement.

Storms struck across Europe from Italy to Britain this weekend. Frome in Somerset (left) was flooded, and in Florence (right) floods wrecked shops on the famous Ponte Vecchio.

68 dead in Italian flood

from GEORGE BLACK: Rome, 5 November

FLOODS, carrying mud and sewage, are feared to have damaged beyond repair many irreplaceable works of art in Northern Italy.

The historic cities of Florence, Venice and Siena were among the worst hit places. At least 68 people are feared dead, thousands are injured, and tens of thousands made homeless.

Officials said the water had caused more damage to Florence and its art treasures than all the fighting around the city in the Second World War.

The Arno River, fed by two weeks of heavy rain, spilled over its banks yesterday, and poured in torrents through the narrow streets of the city. It was feared that the Ponte Vecchio, the fourteenth-century fortress-like bridge spanning the Arno, might collapse. Goldsmiths' shops, which once made the bridge one of Italy's greatest tourist attractions, disappeared.

Archives lost

Two-thirds of the city was flooded at the Arno burst its banks. It has now subsided, but today many quarters are without power, light or drinking water. Food and medical aid are being flown in by helicopters. The inside of the cathedral and the Baptistery, like the great Piazza della Signoria, were a quagmire today.

In the Uffizi Gallery, the Renaissance treasure-house of the Medici, the entire photographic archives of 130,000 negatives were destroyed besides a number of original works that were being restored. One, by Giotto, was saved in the nick of time. The bronze gates of the eleventh-

Storms hit west

NON-STOP rain brought chaos to the West Country yesterday. Flood-water on roads was more than four feet deep in places.

Rail links between London and South Wales were disrupted when a water-logged bank collapsed on to the line between Chipping Sodbury and Badminton, in Gloucestershire.

The line was immediately closed. Trains were diverted through Bath, Bristol and Gloucester as workers struggled to move 150 tons of mud from the track.

In Bristol, three inches of rain had fallen in 24 hours. This is normally the city's total for the whole of November. Traffic was halted or reduced to a crawl in several areas.

Chipping Sodbury was left without telephone or road links with Bristol. Frome, in Somerset, was described by the AA as a town 'suddenly cut off from the outside world'. Streets and shops were flooded, and police diverted traffic round the town.

Motoring organisations were inundated with questions about road conditions in the West. In many cases drivers were told: 'Don't try to get through—it isn't worth it.'

The AA warned of further flooding danger, particularly in Blandford, Dorset, and in Bath.

Police in Bath said they would put a flood disaster emergency plan into operation if the River Avon rose another nine inches. Overnight, the

level had risen eight feet above the normal.

Snow fell in parts of the South yesterday. The M1 and M2 motorways were both affected at times.

TODAY'S WEATHER

LONDON, S.E., CENT. S. ENGLAND, E. MIDLANDS, EAST ANGLIA, CHANNEL ISLANDS: Dull with rain at times. Perhaps becoming brighter later. Wind N.E. to N., moderate or fresh locally strong. Rather cold, max. temp. 8C, 46F.

S.W. ENGLAND: Becoming brighter with showers and sunny intervals. Wind N.E. to N., moderate or fresh locally strong. Rather cold, max. temp. 9C, 48F.

N. WALES, S. WALES AND MONMOUTHSHIRE, E. AND CENT. N. ENGLAND: Cloudy at first, becoming brighter later with scattered showers. Winds N.E. to N., moderate. Rather cold, max. temp. 9C, 48F.

N. WALES, ISLE OF MAN, BORDERS, EDINBURGH AND E. SCOTLAND, S.W. SCOTLAND, GLASGOW, ARGYLL AND N. IRELAND: Sunny periods and scattered showers. Wind N.E. to N., moderate to fresh. Rather cold, max. temp. 8C, 46F.

LAKE DISTRICT, N.W. AND N.E. ENGLAND: Mostly cloudy with scattered showers. Some snow over high ground. Winds N.E. to N., moderate or fresh. Rather cold, max. temp. 8C, 46F.

OUTLOOK: Sunny periods and showers.

Wilson-Brown Market clash

by NORA BELOFF, our Political Correspondent

A SPLIT has developed between the Prime Minister and George Brown, the Foreign Secretary, over when and on what terms Britain should renew her bid to join the Common Market.

Mr Heath's dramatic challenge to the Government yesterday to go beyond vague declarations and spell out its precise intentions reflects views privately held by both Mr Brown and Mr George Thomson, Chancellor of the Duchy of Lancaster, who has responsibility for Common Market matters.

Both have met all the West European leaders, and have already told their Cabinet colleagues that clarification of policy is essential. Common Market advocates in the Cabinet—and they are in a substantial majority—are wondering whether Mr Wilson is merely over-optimistic in thinking he can obtain entry on very much better terms than those negotiated by Mr Heath, or whether he intends deliberately to provoke another rebuff which will put the issue of Britain's exclusion on General G. Gaulle.

Differences

The differences of view have not prevented the continuation of Cabinet talks which are now amounting to intricate quasi-diplomatic negotiations between the Ministers themselves. At the Chequers meeting on Europe it was agreed that decisions were now needed at the top.

George Thomson is understood to have reported that Britain would not be admitted to the Market unless ready to sign the Rome Treaty and accept the subsequent conventions, including the common agricultural policy.

Negotiations would be mainly over price levels and the length of the transition period for adapting Britain's farm policies. Brown and Thomson would like a clear commitment along these lines.

Once this is done the way would be open for unofficial discussions with Britain's prospective partners on concrete issues. The hope would be that this time there would be no official application for entry until the terms were known to be acceptable to all.

The Prime Minister is as fully aware as Mr Brown that, for both international and domestic reasons, something will have to be done. He is particularly anxious to take some new initiative which would be welcome to private business and serve as an encouragement for the much needed revival of capital investment.

He is also convinced that Britain needs wider markets but he believes there may be alternatives to the Common Market.

Some of his advisers, Nicholas Kaldor, for example, would argue that, on purely economic grounds, Britain would do far better in the United States.

There are also vague proposals, which might interest the Prime Minister, for a wider free-trade area, either European or transatlantic, and he feels strongly that Britain would be in a much better position when negotiating with the Market's six nations if she could claim to have alternatives.

The timing of the new initiative is also creating difficulties: it is now widely rumoured that if Britain did join the Six, the pound might be devalued. Mr Wilson is determined to avoid any new risk to sterling which might be provoked by a premature announcement before the pound has fully recovered. He is refusing to be hustled.

The Dutch Foreign Secretary, Dr Josef Luns, died with the Prime Minister last Monday and warned him that if Britain wanted to join the Six she must accept the Treaty of Rome and all subsequent conventions.

He insisted that this was the position from which Britain must bargain with the French, and could not expect her allies to mediate for her. But he certainly did not get the impression that Mr Wilson had accepted this verdict, or was ready to act on it.

Time is short, says Heath: Page 2

Brown going to Moscow

Moscow, 5 November.—Mr George Brown, the Foreign Secretary, will make an informal visit to Moscow on 22-23 November, it was announced tonight.—AP

Full report: Page 5

So polite, this North Sea spy game

by ANDREW WILSON, our Defence Correspondent

THE RAF photograph of a Soviet Bison bomber being escorted away from Britain by Lightning interceptors disclosed last week only one incident in a game of high-altitude peek-a-booo which has been going on continuously for a considerable time.

In one week recently there were 16 interceptions of various types of Soviet aircraft on reconnaissance over the North Sea.

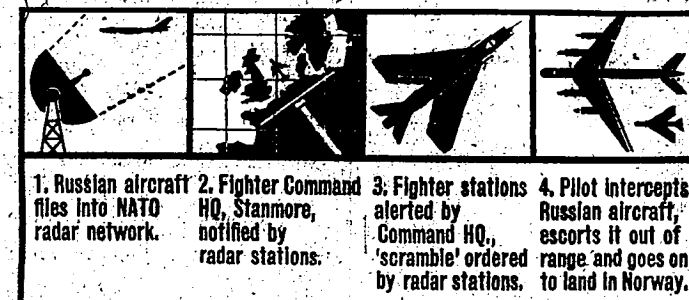
Most of the aircraft—Bison, Bear and Badger bombers—have returned to their bases in northern Russia without venturing closer than 100 miles off the British mainland. But one has flown within 10 miles of the Shetland Islands.

The object of these missions is thought to be threefold: (1) oblique

radar photography, which at the most common interception altitude (about 38,000 ft), becomes possible up to 240 miles from the coast; (2) electronic searching for NATO radar frequencies; a mission also performed by Soviet fighters; (3) testing the alertness of NATO air defences.

The four-engined Bison, with a 7,000-mile range, is a newcomer to the North Sea reconnaissance game. The most common 'intruder' is the turbo-propeller Bear, which is capable, in its strike role, of attacking targets in North America. During the past month, for unexplained reasons, the Bears have been flying farther south than they used to.

No sinister motives are attributed to the Russians, who are legally entitled to fly where they wish, so long as they do not infringe our airspace. Moreover, their pilots are said to act very correctly. But, the Soviet



patrols, including night movements, present a round-the-clock challenge to the alertness of RAF Fighter Command.

First warning of a Russian aircraft approaching is an identified 'blip' on the network of NATO radar screens stretching far north and south of the British Isles. Such 'blips' are

immediately checked against the flight plans which must be filed by all civil aircraft and are supplied every day to Command headquarters at Stanmore, near London.

If there is no registered flight corresponding with the 'blip' Fighter Command authorises the appropriate fighter units to 'scramble' (take off

for action). But the actual order to take off is given by a master radar station, which knows the intruder's course, the best interception point and, therefore, the right moment to get airborne.

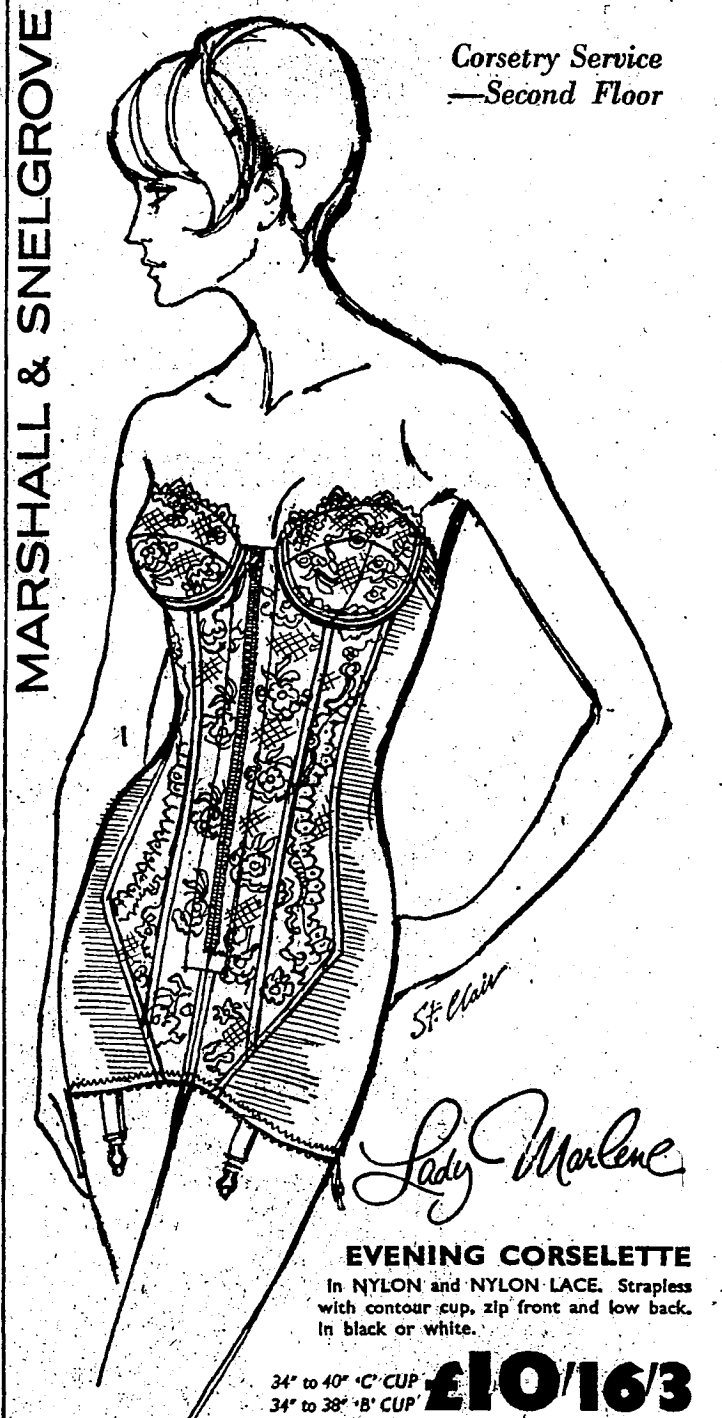
Lightnings on alert can take off in seconds and reach 40,000 ft in two minutes. But for peacetime interceptions they more often fly subsonically towards their target, conserving super-sonic capacity until it is wanted. The final interception is made by the aircraft's own radar and computer, giving the pilot his course. He does not actually see his quarry until he is within a couple of miles of it.

The interceptor stays with the intruder for about 10 minutes. The Russian crew wave coffee breakers from their cockpit. The RAF responds with V-signs. If the Russian aircraft is taking its time—and most of them are—the interceptors may 'shadow' it in turns. Or they may follow the Russians across the North Sea and land in Norway.

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